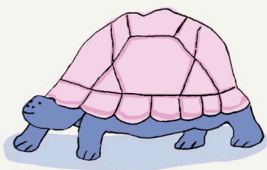


But she was still learning. Elizabeth had to concentrate, listen, and look the part. She knew that everyone she met would remember that time always.

Her tours had magic moments. In Tonga, for example, she met a tortoise left as a gift in the 1770s by the British explorer Captain Cook.



At home, Elizabeth's duties included weekly meetings with the Prime Minister. Her first prime minister was Winston Churchill, a trusted friend who was eager to give advice. Often their chats lasted 90 minutes or more, covering anything from atom bombs to horse racing.

WINSTON CHURCHILL

When Elizabeth was crowned, Winston Churchill was almost 80. He had led the UK during World War II, and yet he was nervous at first about working with a queen who, to him, seemed "a mere child." For her part, Elizabeth was in awe of the world-famous statesman, but they got along well. After Churchill retired in 1955, she missed their meetings. They were "always such fun" she said.

